

CRISTOFF STAN

Senior Software Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Experienced and detail-oriented Backend Engineer with 7+ years of hands-on experience in Python, Django, RESTful API development, and PostgreSQL. Proven expertise in building scalable financial and SaaS systems, cloud-native architectures, and highly available backend infrastructures. Seeking to contribute to a fast-growing fintech company with a strong engineering culture and impactful product goals.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages & Frameworks:** Python, Django, Flask, FastAPI, JavaScript, Node.js
- **API Development:** REST, OpenAPI, Postman, Swagger
- **Databases:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQLite, Redis
- **Cloud & DevOps:** AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda), Docker, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI/CD
- **Security & Testing:** JWT, OAuth2, Pytest, Unit/Integration Testing, SSL, HTTPS
- **Monitoring & Logging:** Prometheus, Grafana, ELK stack
- **Tools:** Git, Docker, Nginx, Celery, RabbitMQ, Terraform, JIRA

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

Sensidev

September 2021 – December 2024

Timișoara, Romania (Remote)

- Led backend development for core financial products using Django and PostgreSQL, ensuring scalability, performance, and security in a microservices environment.
- Designed and implemented over 25 RESTful APIs supporting thousands of B2B customer transactions, using Django REST Framework and token-based authentication.
- Collaborated across distributed teams to migrate legacy PHP and Flask-based APIs to a modern Django stack, reducing response times by 42% and improving maintainability.
- Built asynchronous processing pipelines using Celery and RabbitMQ for handling intensive invoice and payment workflows with near real-time updates.
- Developed database schemas optimized for high transaction throughput, resulting in 30% improvement in query performance using PostgreSQL indexing strategies.
- Implemented CI/CD pipelines via GitLab and Docker to automate deployments, ensuring consistency and reducing release cycle times from weekly to daily.
- Integrated AWS services including S3 for document storage and RDS for relational databases, achieving 99.99% availability and secure encrypted storage.

- Spearheaded the introduction of test-driven development practices with Pytest, increasing code coverage to over 85% across modules.

Software Engineer

Syscom Digital

October 2019 – August 2021

Bucharest, Romania (Remote)

- Engineered backend APIs for client campaign platforms, primarily using Django and Flask, handling over 10 million API calls per month with horizontal scalability.
- Optimized PostgreSQL database structures and queries, reducing report generation latency by 55% through use of materialized views and query caching.
- Designed modular microservices architecture enabling independent deployment of campaign modules, resulting in 40% reduction in regression defects.
- Deployed and maintained backend applications on AWS EC2 and ECS, introducing monitoring with Prometheus and alerting via Grafana dashboards.
- Implemented role-based access control and security layers to ensure GDPR compliance across customer data pipelines and processing modules.
- Participated in weekly architecture reviews and system audits, proposing refactor plans that decreased technical debt across four legacy services.
- Wrote integration test suites using Pytest and Postman collections to validate service interoperability across multiple marketing channels.
- Mentored 2 junior developers and introduced pair programming sessions, increasing delivery velocity and onboarding efficiency.

Software Developer

Soft Build

June 2016 – July 2019

Timișoara, Romania (Remote)

- Delivered core backend components for property and asset management tools using Django and PostgreSQL, streamlining data entry and report workflows.
- Built REST APIs and admin portals using Django Admin, exposing critical data endpoints to external partners through token-authenticated routes.
- Managed infrastructure provisioning using Docker Compose and Ansible, cutting onboarding time for developers and QA engineers by over 50%.
- Developed and optimized background task queues using Celery to handle bulk data import and export tasks for large Excel datasets.
- Refactored old Python 2.7 codebases to Python 3.6+ with full test coverage, reducing support issues and preparing the codebase for cloud migration.
- Implemented automated testing and versioning through Git hooks and CI tools, enforcing high-quality code practices.
- Enhanced query performance by analyzing slow logs and rewriting ORM logic with raw SQL where necessary, improving load times on analytics dashboards.
- Conducted peer reviews and wrote documentation to support ongoing knowledge sharing and handover processes within the team.

Software Developer
Decima Digital
November 2015 – April 2016
Tallinn, Estonia

- Developed e-commerce modules using Python and Django, integrating payment gateways with PCI-compliant encryption and API protection.
- Created user-friendly APIs for mobile applications with rate limiting and token refresh strategies, improving security and user experience.
- Automated deployment of development and staging environments using Docker and shell scripts, ensuring consistency across test cycles.
- Built custom middleware to handle session tracking and logging across microservices for fraud detection and usage analytics.
- Used Django ORM optimizations and PostgreSQL partitioning to support data archiving and faster reporting.
- Conducted integration testing and documentation of new endpoints, supporting app developers across web and mobile platforms.
- Developed and maintained internal tools for sales data analysis using pandas and matplotlib.
- Participated in sprint planning, bug triage, and retrospectives, contributing to Agile culture adoption within the team.

Software Developer Intern
Borna Technology
September 2014 – August 2015
Tallinn, Estonia (On-Site)

- Assisted with backend development of internal CRM using Django and MySQL, supporting the sales and customer support teams.
- Created REST endpoints for contact and account management with JWT-based authentication and fine-grained access control.
- Wrote backend logic for tracking lead status and automated notification emails using Celery with SMTP integration.
- Performed unit and manual testing of new modules, helping reduce bug count by identifying edge cases early.
- Documented internal API structure using Swagger/OpenAPI for improved onboarding and external API consumption.
- Implemented basic analytics dashboard with chart visualizations using Chart.js and Django templates.
- Created Python scripts to automate lead import/export processes, reducing manual effort and data duplication.
- Attended development stand-ups and retrospectives, gaining hands-on exposure to Agile workflows and project lifecycle.

EDUCATION

Tallinn University

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science,
2010 – 2014

CERTIFICATIONS

- ❖ AWS Certified Developer – Associate
 - ❖ Django for Web Developers – Udemy
 - ❖ Secure Software Development – Coursera
 - ❖ Test-Driven Development with Python – Test Automation University
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PROJECTS

FinanceHub API Gateway

- Led the backend architecture for a B2B finance platform API using Django and DRF; handled partner authentication, rate limiting, and multi-tenant data access control.
- Integrated PostgreSQL and Redis to handle high-volume transaction logs and time-sensitive token caching with precision.

InvoiceSync (Microservices Transition Project)

- Migrated legacy invoice processing system to microservices using Django + Celery with RabbitMQ, enhancing error recovery and scaling capabilities.
- Reduced downtime to <1% monthly and enabled real-time alerting using Prometheus and ELK stack integration.

SecurePay Integration Service

- Built a secure payment microservice using Django, PostgreSQL, and AWS Lambda with API Gateway and CloudWatch monitoring.
- Introduced token-based access for third-party vendors and improved API reliability score to 99.99%.